



PASSWORD MANAGEMENT PROCEDURE

ORGANIZATION: CYBER CONNECT

DEPARTMENT: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

VERSION 1.0

Ref:

Dated: April 06, 2026

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DOCUMENT INFORMATION

Category	Information
Document	Password Management Procedure
Version	1.0
Identifier	
Status	Uncontrolled
Author(s)	Rameen Mughal
Reviewer(s)	GRC Mentor
Approver(s)	Chief Executive Officer
Creation Date	April 06, 2026
Effective Date	April 12, 2026
Control Status	Planned
Distribution	IT Department, CEO
Disclaimer	

VERSION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Approved By	Description
1.0	April 06, 2026	Rameen Mughal	GRC Mentor	Draft

INTRODUCTION

This Password Management Procedure outlines the steps and processes for creating, managing, and protecting passwords within Cyber Connect. It ensures that all users follow a consistent and secure approach in accordance with the Password Management Policy, helping to safeguard IT systems and sensitive data from unauthorized access.

PURPOSE

The purpose of this procedure is to ensure a consistent and secure approach to password creation, usage, storage, and management to protect organizational systems and data.

SCOPE

This procedure applies to all employees within the IT department of Cyber Connect and covers all systems, applications, and devices managed by the IT team.

DEFINITIONS

- Password:** A confidential string of characters used to authenticate a user and grant access to systems or applications.
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** A security mechanism that requires users to provide two or more verification factors (e.g., password and OTP) to gain access.
- Privileged Account:** An account with elevated access rights used for administrative or critical system functions.
- Account Lockout:** A security control that disables a user account after a defined number of failed login attempts.
- Password Reset:** The process of assigning a new password to a user after verifying their identity.
- Password Manager:** A secure tool used to store and manage passwords in an encrypted format.
- Authentication:** The process of verifying the identity of a user attempting to access a system.

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Role	Responsibilities
CEO	Approves and supports enforcement
IT Officer	Implements controls, handles resets, monitors logs
IT Employees	Follow password rules and report issues

PROCEDURES

1. General Password Management

- IT Officer ensures all systems enforce password complexity rules
- Default passwords must be changed at first login
- Password storage in plain text is strictly prohibited

2. Password Creation Procedure

- User creates password during account setup following:
 - Minimum **8–12 characters**
 - Must include uppercase, lowercase, numbers, special characters
- System automatically rejects weak or non-compliant passwords
- Users are prevented from using:
 - Personal information
 - Username-based passwords
 - Common passwords

3. Password Usage Procedure

- Users must:
 - Keep passwords confidential
 - Avoid writing passwords in accessible places
 - Ensure passwords are not visible during entry
- System access is restricted to the authorized account owner only

4. Password Change and Expiry Procedure

- System enforces password change periodically
- System prevents reuse of last **3–5 passwords**
- Users must immediately change password if compromise is suspected

5. Password Reset Procedure

- User requests reset via:
 - IT helpdesk or authorized system
- IT Officer performs identity verification
- Temporary password is issued securely
- User must change password at first login
- All reset actions must be logged

6. Privileged Account Password Management

- IT Officer ensures:
 - Stronger password complexity for privileged accounts
 - Restricted access to privileged credentials
- Password change enforced:
 - Every **60 days**
- Immediate change required if compromise suspected
- Sharing of privileged credentials is prohibited

7. Account Lockout Procedure

- System locks account after **5 failed login attempts**
- User must contact IT for reactivation
- IT verifies identity before unlocking account

8. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Procedure

- IT enables MFA on:
 - Critical systems
 - Sensitive accounts
- If MFA is not available:
 - Apply compensating controls such as:
 - VPN access
 - IP restrictions

9. Monitoring and Logging

- IT Officer monitors:
 - Login attempts
 - Password resets
 - Privileged account access
- Suspicious activities are investigated immediately

DOCUMENTATION & RETENTION

All password-related records including resets, changes, and access logs must be retained for a minimum of **six (6) years** or as required by law.

COMPLIANCE / ENFORCEMENT

Failure to follow this procedure may result in disciplinary action, including termination and legal consequences.

REVIEW & REVISION

This procedure will be reviewed annually by the Security Officer and IT leadership, and updated as necessary to reflect technological, organizational, or regulatory changes.

Approved By

Date: 06/04/2026